

The Business Behemoth

A look at HP's 2300 DTN ought to change your perception of a business printer. This giant means business and is designed to reflect that attitude—from its core components to its looks.

The 2300 DTN has separate ink tanks and replaceable print heads. The ink tanks by themselves are voluminous compared to those on other HP models, and models from other vendors.

Paper capacity is humongous, and apart from the inbuilt paper tray, HP provides an additional paper cassette. In total, 650 sheets can be fed into this giant at once. Duplex printing is a welcome



The HP 2300 DTN

feature. The 2300 DTN comes with 64 MB of onboard memory, upgradeable to 320 MB.

The 2300 DTN has both a Parallel and a USB 2.0 port. For hooking it up on your internal LAN, it has a JetDirect internal print

server, which is easy to install.

The printer is not the fastest. On an average, it takes four seconds more than the Canon Pixma iP4000, which is the fastest printer we tested this time. As for quality, the output is not very good; HP's DJ-5652 inkjet has far superior print quality and costs five times less.

The 2300 DTN will set you back by Rs 50,000. It is worth noting that the printer is a relatively old model. We would advise that you evaluate this printer more carefully, keeping in mind that the HP 2550L laser printer might make more purchase sense for your organisation.

In the Lexmark and Samsung, the toner cartridges are lined up vertically, over which the paper passes, whereas in the HP, Canon and Wipro, the toner cartridges are mounted on a rotating carousel, and move to apply the specified colour on the paper. This results in added time to complete the same task.

In the text printout, under Best mode, all the printers, except for the Samsung CLP-500, returned the same time. Samsung came out on tops here.

In printing the point-size document, the results remained the same; the Samsung CLP-500 came out tops, followed by the Lexmark C510. Wipro did well, keeping ahead of the HP and Canon printers.

The results of the combi-document test were interesting: the document is heavy in terms of colourful graphical elements, and hence taxes most printers to the max. It also does a fair job of emulating real-world printing scenarios. The Samsung was the fastest with 24 seconds—25 per cent faster than the runner-up, the Canon LBP-2410, which clocked 32 seconds. Canon's CAPT technology works in its favour here.

The Lexmark took the longest time, a result that was repeated in tests where we used large or complex documents. The reason is the slow spooling-time; once a document is spooled, the C510 from Lexmark is a firecracker. HP's LaserJet 2550L was marginally faster than the C510.

When we printed the combi-document in Best mode, the Samsung lost the top slot by a small margin to Canon's steady-performing LBP-2410. The other printers followed with similar times, to complete the job.

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